

Saturday, 8 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

28° 18°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

27° 13°

MANCHESTER

Overcast

26° 13°

GLASGOW

Heavy drizzle

19° 13°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1

The Defence Secretary has said he is 'sickened' by the claims of sex abuse at an Army college in North Yorkshire.

Grant Shapps has promised a thorough investigation into what went wrong at the college. This follows allegations of serious misconduct and abuse within the institution.

CRIME · UK

2

The new Prime Minister, Andy Burnham, is facing his first major test in office over the ongoing prison overcrowding crisis.

The situation presents Mr Burnham with a difficult dilemma, as there are only unpalatable choices to address the issue. This is a significant challenge early in his premiership.

POLITICS · UK

3

An 11-year-old girl has been found dead after a search at a beauty spot in Midlothian, Scotland.

Emergency crews were called to Gore Water on Thursday afternoon after the alarm was raised. Police have launched an investigation into the circumstances of her death.

TRAGEDY · UK

4

A serial sex offender, who was being monitored by the Metropolitan Police, has been found guilty of murdering two women and raping a third.

Simon Levy's crimes have raised serious questions about police oversight. Senior Met officers have admitted that his second murder victim could have been saved.

CRIME · UK

5

Two companies have been found guilty over the death of a man who was killed by a falling window in London.

Mick Ferris was tragically hit by glass that fell from a luxury tower block on Albert Embankment. The incident highlights concerns about construction safety.

ACCIDENT · UK

What's coming up

1 **Fans are hoping for new Fugees music after Lauryn Hill revealed the band is in an 'amazing place' after 30 years.**

Lauryn Hill and Wyclef Jean have reportedly gone through an 'incredible healing process'. This has raised the exciting prospect of a new album.

ON AIR – Are you excited for new music from The Fugees? What's your favourite Fugees track?

MUSIC · COMING UP

2 **Rihanna is back 'in the studio' and 'cooking' up new music, according to her partner A\$AP Rocky.**

The superstar singer last released a full album in 2016, so fans have been eagerly awaiting new material. This news will certainly get people talking!

ON AIR – What kind of sound are you hoping for from Rihanna's new music? Do you miss her in the charts?

MUSIC · COMING UP

3 **Emmerdale actor Lawrence Robb, known for playing Mackenzie 'Mack' Boyd, is joining the line-up for Strictly Come Dancing!**

The popular soap star has also appeared in 'I Hate Suzie'. He'll be swapping the Dales for the dancefloor, hoping to impress the judges.

ON AIR – Are you excited to see Lawrence Robb on Strictly? Who would you love to see join the show?

TV · COMING UP

4 **A new exhibition celebrating the legendary Sir Billy Connolly is coming to Glasgow in 2027.**

Billy Connolly's 'Big Wee Exhibition' will open at the city's Kelvingrove Art Gallery next June. It promises a unique insight into the life and career of 'The Big Yin'.

ON AIR – Are you a big fan of Billy Connolly? What's your favourite memory or routine of his?

EXHIBITION · COMING UP

5 **The promoter behind Oasis's iconic Knebworth concerts has been granted a licence for future events at the park.**

This isn't the first time rumours of a return to Knebworth Park have circulated. It's sparking speculation about who might perform there next.

ON AIR – Who would you love to see headline Knebworth next? Could Oasis ever reform for a show there?

MUSIC · COMING UP

On the schedule

1 Assistant referee Sian Massey-Ellis has announced her retirement from officiating to take up a role with the Football Association.

Massey-Ellis has been a pioneering figure in football officiating. Her move to the FA marks a new chapter in her career.

ON AIR – What's your favourite memory of Sian Massey-Ellis on the pitch? What impact do you think she'll have at the FA?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 England forward Ivan Toney has been charged with assault following an incident back in December.

The 30-year-old, who was part of England's World Cup squad this summer, is due to appear in court next month. This is a developing story.

ON AIR – How do you think this might impact Toney's career? What are your thoughts on players facing charges?

FOOTBALL · UK

3 Hampshire and England fast bowler John Turner has retired from cricket at the age of 25 due to injury.

Turner had been out of action for over a year. His early retirement is a sad loss for English cricket.

ON AIR – It's always tough when a promising career is cut short by injury, isn't it? What are your memories of John Turner?

CRICKET · UK

4 London Spirit have become the first team to be eliminated from The Hundred after losing to MI London at Lord's.

MI London secured a four-wicket victory in front of a record crowd. Melie Kerr played a magnificent lone hand with the bat to keep MI London's faint qualification hopes alive.

ON AIR – Are you following The Hundred this year? Which team are you backing?

CRICKET · UK

5 West Ham co-owner David Sullivan is expected to attend Saturday's EFL Cup tie despite advice to stay away from home matches.

Sullivan has reportedly been advised to avoid London Stadium due to ongoing fan unrest. His presence will likely be a talking point among supporters.

ON AIR – Do you think club owners should always attend matches, even when there's tension with fans? What's your take on this?

FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 The surprising joy of 'puddle jumping' is making a comeback amongst adults seeking simple, unadulterated fun.**
Childhood activities are being rediscovered as stress-busters, with splashing through puddles topping the list for its instant mood-boosting effect. It seems a bit of unexpected dampness is good for the soul!
- 2 Researchers highlight the unique benefits of 'listening to the radio whilst cooking' for enhanced creativity in the kitchen.**
Having a favourite programme or music on in the background can transform a mundane chore into a joyful experience, encouraging more adventurous culinary experiments. Who knew a good playlist could inspire a gourmet meal?
- 3 A new study reveals that 'the art of arranging books by colour' is becoming a popular way to personalise home decor.**
Beyond simple organisation, colour-coded bookshelves are being embraced as a creative outlet, turning functional storage into eye-catching displays. It's less about the genre and more about the spectrum!
- 4 The humble 'tea towel' is evolving into a fashionable accessory for home kitchens, with intricate designs and luxurious fabrics.**
Once a purely practical item, tea towels are now seen as a way to inject personality and style into the heart of the home. Forget plain white, it's all about artistic flair now!
- 5 Experts are praising the meditative qualities of 'watching clouds drift by' for promoting mindfulness and relaxation.**
Taking a moment to observe the ever-changing shapes in the sky is being suggested as a simple yet effective way to de-stress and reconnect with nature. It's free, it's easy, and it's always there!
- 6 The trend of 'swapping magazines with neighbours' is fostering community spirit and reducing waste.**
Instead of discarding old copies, people are creating informal exchange networks, allowing everyone to enjoy a wider variety of reads without buying new. It's a lovely way to share and connect!
- 7 A report indicates a rise in popularity for 'visiting local market towns' for unique shopping experiences and supporting independent businesses.**
Escaping the big city and exploring the charm of smaller towns offers a more personal and enjoyable shopping trip, often uncovering hidden gems. It's a lovely day out with a bit of retail therapy thrown in!

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to decide what to wear in the morning, even though we know it might not be the most practical approach?

ANSWER: TRYING ON AT LEAST THREE DIFFERENT OUTFITS, JUST IN CASE!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, hot chocolate. What is it?

ANSWER: STIRRING IT CLOCKWISE EXACTLY FIVE TIMES, THEN ANTI-CLOCKWISE FIVE TIMES!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes you spot a 'random object' in a really unexpected place, and it just makes you smile or wonder?

From a rubber duck on a bus stop to a lone slipper in a field, what's the most surprising thing you've ever seen somewhere it absolutely shouldn't be, and what did you make of it?

- We all have those 'little personal traditions' or habits that we do every time a particular season rolls around, don't we?

Whether it's a certain meal you always make in autumn or a specific piece of music you play when spring arrives, what are your seasonal rituals that mark the turning of the year?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that sloths can hold their breath longer than dolphins? They can hold it for up to 40 minutes, while dolphins can only manage about 10 minutes.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The Northern Lights, or Aurora Borealis, can sometimes be seen as far south as the coast of Cornwall, but only during exceptionally strong solar flares and clear, moonless nights.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The tiny country of San Marino is the oldest surviving republic in the world, founded in 301 AD.
- A 'floccinaucinihilipilification' is the act or habit of estimating something as worthless.
- The world's largest grand piano was built by a New Zealander and is over 5.78 metres long.
- Before alarm clocks, there were 'knocker-uppers' in Britain who would tap on windows with a long stick to wake people for work.
- The sound of crinkling cellophane is the loudest natural sound a moth can hear, triggering an escape response.
- Vending machines in Japan sell everything from hot meals to fresh flowers.
- The first British person to receive a speeding ticket was Walter Arnold in 1896, for going 8 mph in a 2 mph zone.
- The human nose can remember 50,000 different scents.

On this day

Day 220 of the year, 145 days left in 2026. Today Ceasefire Day (end of Iran–Iraq War) (Iraqi Kurdistan); Christian Feast Day: Altmann of Passau; Christian Feast Day: Bonifacia Rodríguez y Castro; Christian Feast Day: Cyriacus and companions. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1947 — Larry Wilcox, American actor, director, and producer
- 1962 — Kool Moe Dee, American musician, singer and actor
- 1949 — Terry Burnham, American actress (died 2013)
- 1951 — Martin Brest, American director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1973 — Mark Wills, American singer-songwriter
- 1980 — Michael Urie, American actor, director, and producer
- 1964 — Paul Taylor, English cricketer
- 1989 — Ken Baumann, American actor and author

THE DAY TODAY

- 2007 — Space Shuttle program: STS-118 Mission: Endeavour takes off on a mission to the International Space Station.
- 2022 — The Federal Bureau of Investigation (FBI) executes a search warrant at former president Donald Trump's residence in Mar-a-Lago, Palm Beach, Florida.
- 2001 — Albanian rebels ambush a convoy of the Army of the Republic of Macedonia near Tetovo, killing 10 soldiers.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2004 — A tour bus belonging to the Dave Matthews Band dumps approximately 800 pounds of human waste onto a boat full of passengers.
- 2019 — An explosion at the State Central Navy Testing Range in Nyonoksa, Russia, kills five people.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1973 — Kim Dae-jung, a South Korean politician and later president of South Korea, is kidnapped.
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2008 — A EuroCity express train en route from Kraków, Poland to Prague, Czech Republic strikes a part of a motorway bridge that had fallen onto the railroad track near Studénka railway station in the Czech Republic and derails, killing eight people and injuring 64 others.

- 2010 — China Floods: A mudslide in Zhugqu County, Gansu, China, kills more than 1,400 people.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 221 of the year, 144 days left in 2026. Today Battle of Gangut Day (Russia); Christian feast day: Candida Maria of Jesus; Christian feast day: Edith Stein (St Teresa Benedicta of the Cross); Christian feast day: Firmus and Rusticus. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1984 — Paul Gallagher, Scottish footballer
- 1958 — Amanda Bearse, American actress, comedian and director
- 1947 — Barbara Mason, American R&B/soul singer-songwriter
- 1970 — Thomas Lennon, American actor and comedian
- 1972 — Ryan Bollman, American actor
- 1959 — Kurtis Blow, American rapper, producer, and actor
- 1939 — Butch Warren, American bassist (died 2013)
- 1991 — Alice Barlow, English actress

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1995 — Aviateca Flight 901 crashes into the San Vicente volcano in El Salvador, killing all 65 people on board.
- 1944 — The United States Forest Service and the Wartime Advertising Council release posters featuring Smokey Bear for the first time.
- 1960 — South Kasai secedes from the Congo.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1944 — World War II: Continuation War: The Vyborg–Petrozavodsk Offensive, the largest offensive launched by Soviet Union against Finland during the Second World War, ends to a strategic stalemate. Both Finnish and Soviet troops at the Finnish front dug to defensive positions, and the...
- 2021 — The Tampere light rail officially starts operating.

Coming to cinemas

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar

AUGUST 2026

W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)